

Collects and Biographies for

Saints' Days & Festivals

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

March

Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

Key to Abbreviations

CCP	Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)
ECUSA	Episcopal Church of the United States of America
F	Black Letter Saints' Days (W.H. Frere; SPCK, 1961)
I	Church of Ireland
MEG	Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon
R	The Roman Missal (1970)
SA	An Anglican Prayer Book (Church of the Province of Southern Africa) 1989
SEC	Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects
SL	Scottish Liturgy, Propers: Saints Days (ringbound version)
SPB	Scottish Prayer Book 1929, as amended in 1967
W	The Prayer Book of the Church in Wales

Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E. Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J. M. Saunders, Edinburgh, June – October 2003.

Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.02

1 MARCH

David, Bishop, Patron of Wales (c.544) [6] *White*

Born probably in Cardigan around the end of the 5th century, David (or Dewi) received his early training from Saint Illtyd. He attracted many postulants to the monasteries he founded, all of which were remarkable for the austerity of their rule of life. Despite his yearning for solitude for study and meditation, he proved to be an effective leader in combating the Pelagian heresy.*

Consecrated bishop, it is believed in Jerusalem, he was recognised as the chief bishop of Wales, and established his see at the monastery of which he was abbot in the place now called Saint David's. He died in about the year AD 601 as had been regarded as the patron saint for Wales since at least the twelfth century.

* Pelagius said that man was basically good and had control of his own eternal destiny, thereby denying the doctrine of original sin, and by extension, the necessity for and the efficacy of Christ's sacrifice on the cross.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who in love towards thy people
didst call Saint David
to be a faithful and wise steward
of thy mysteries;
Mercifully grant that,
following his purity of life and zeal
for the whole Gospel of Christ,
we may with him receive
thy heavenly reward;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(W)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Grant, Lord,
that as we give thanks
for the life and work
of your servant David,
so your church in Wales
may faithfully preach the gospel
which he proclaimed,
and build on the foundation
which he laid;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SL)

2 MARCH

Chad of Lichfield, Bishop (672) [6] *White*

Chad was a pupil of Saint Aiden at Lindisfarne, and succeeded his brother Cedd as abbot of Lastingham in Yorkshire, from where he was called to be Bishop of York, and consecrated by British bishops. The Roman Mission in England had designated Wilfrid to that see, and declared Chad's consecration irregular. Chad modestly retired to Lastingham, saying that he had never considered himself worthy of the office. His humility so impressed Archbishop Theodore that he soon consecrated him as Bishop of Mercia. He made the monastery at Lichfield the centre of his activities. Bede gives him an attractive portrait of his holiness and simplicity of life. He died, a victim of the plague, in 672.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O almighty God,
who didst call Saint Chad
to be an evangelist and bishop
of his own people:
give us grace so to follow
his peaceable temper, humble spirit,
and prayerful life,
that we truly commend to others
the faith which we ourselves profess;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
from the first-fruits
of the English nation
you called your servant Chad
to be an evangelist and bishop
of his own people:
give us grace to the follow
his peaceable nature, humble spirit
and prayerful life,
that we may truly
commend to others
the faith which we ourselves profess;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

3 MARCH

John and Charles Wesley, Priests (1791, 1788) [6] *White*

The Wesley brothers were born in Lincolnshire at the start of the 18th century. At Oxford a group of earnest and devout scholars, nicknamed Methodists, gather around them. Both went briefly as missionaries to Georgia after ordination. After conversion experiences, they devoted themselves to an itinerant preaching ministry seeking to touch those who were not being reached by the ministry of the Established Church.

Charles, a prolific hymn-writer, remained within the Church of England to his death in 1788. John organized a group of lay pastors to follow up his field-preaching, but hostility to his renewal movement led eventually to the emergence of a separate Methodist Church. A man of deep piety and charity with great gifts of leadership and organization, John died in 1791.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
by whose Spirit
thy Church is renewed in every age,
we give thee thanks
for all whom thou dost call
to be the human agents of renewal,
especially for John and Charles

Wesley,
through whose preaching
and teaching
many souls were won for Christ:
breathe thy Spirit
upon thy Church today,
and grant us the courage
and faithfulness
to recognize His work among us
and to submit ourselves
to His influence;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God of mercy;
who inspired
John and Charles Wesley
with zeal for your gospel:
grant to all your people
boldness to proclaim your word
and ever to rejoice
in singing your praises;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

4 MARCH

Adrian of May Island, Abbot, and Companions, Martyrs (875) **[6] *Red***

According to tradition, Adrian was a Hungarian of royal descent, who settled in Fife with many companions to evangelize the Picts. During the Viking raids he is said to have softened the raiders' fury and even converted some, but in one fierce raid in AD 875, Adrian and his companions withdrew to the Island of May (off the coast of Crail, in the Firth of Forth) where they were martyred. The island, with a monastery founded by King David I, became an important centre of pilgrimage.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
who dost inspire us
to confess thy holy Name
by the witness of thy martyrs:
grant that thy Church,
encouraged by the example
of Adrian and his Companions,
may be ready to suffer fearlessly
for thy cause,
and to strive for the reward
of thy heavenly glory;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

By the witness
of your martyrs, Lord,
you inspire us to confess
your holy Name:
grant that the example
of Adrian and his Companions
may encourage your Church
to be ready to suffer fearlessly
for your cause,
and to strive for the reward
of your heavenly glory;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F – adapted)

6 MARCH

Baldred, Bishop (608) [6] *White*

Little is known of the life of Baldred, but that he was a hermit, much venerated for the sanctity of his life, who lived on the Bass Rock, off the coast of East Lothian, probably at the end of the 6th century. He may have been Kentigern's successor as Bishop at Glasgow. He died on this day in the year AD 608.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who dost choose thine elect
out of every nation,
and dost show forth
thy glory in their lives:
grant, we pray thee,
that following the example
of thy servant Baldred,
we may be fruitful in good works
to the praise of thy holy Name;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
you choose your servants
from every nation,
and reveal your glory in their lives:
strengthen us to follow
the example of your servant Baldred,
and to be fruitful in good works
to the praise of your holy Name;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB – adapted)

7 MARCH

Perpetua and her Companions, Martyrs (203) [6] *Red*

Perpetua, a young matron of 22, her maid Felicity and her brother, with three slaves, were martyred in Carthage, around the year AD 203, when all except one of the slaves were still catechumens. In prison Perpetua had a vision of a ladder which led to a garden of peace, and with this she comforted and encouraged the group, who were condemned to death by wild beasts. A detailed account of their martyrdom survives—the men died first, but the mistress and her maid, gorged by beasts were despatched by the sword.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
who didst give a splendid courage
to thy blessed martyr Perpetua
and her Companions
most nobly to meet their deaths
for the sake of thy dear Son:
grant that we may be worthy
to climb the ladder of their sacrifice,
and with them be received
into the garden of peace;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord,
who reigneth over
the white host of martyrs
with thee and the Holy Spirit,
God for ever and ever.

(F – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Holy God,
as you gave great courage
to Perpetua and her Companions,
so grant that we
may be made worthy
to climb the ladder of sacrifice
and be received into
the garden of your peace;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(CCP – adapted)

8 MARCH
Duthac, Bishop (1068) [6] *White*

Duthac, Bishop of Ross in the 11th century, studied in Ireland, and was renowned for his zeal in missionary endeavour, his compassion for the poor and for sinners, his willing espousal of poverty and the extreme austerity of his life from childhood. His relics, kept in Tain were an object of pilgrimage through the Middle Ages. He died in 1068.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
who didst dispel
the darkness of the North
through the words and example
of thy blessed Bishop Duthac:
shine, we beseech thee,
with the glory
of thy presence in our hearts,
and enable us to proclaim
the Good News of thy love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG – from SA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God, you dispelled
the darkness of the North
through the words and example
of your holy Bishop Duthac:
shine in our hearts, we pray,
and enable us to proclaim your love;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(MEG – from SA)

10 MARCH
Kessog, Bishop (c.700) [6] *Red*

The memory of many of the saints who brought the light of Christ to Scotland during the Dark Ages is preserved mainly in the dedications of churches in their honour. The name of Kessog (or Mackessock) is thus preserved as a missionary-bishop who laboured among the Picts, probably towards the end of the 7th century. He is said to have been born at Cashel, the capital of Munster, of the race of the kings of Ireland, and the chief area of his mission seems to have been the lands of Lennox. He is said to have been martyred near Luss on Loch Lomondside around the year AD 700.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O eternal Lord God,
by whose Spirit
thy servant Kessog
laboured to spread
the light of the good news
of thy love across this land:
by that same Spirit
strengthen thy Church
to tell our the greatness of thy love,
and to express it in acts of service,
for love of him
who came not to be served
but to serve,
thy Son our Saviour Jesus Christ.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Lord of all ages,
your servant Kessog
laboured in the power of your Spirit
to spread the light
of the good news of your love
across this land:
by that same Spirit
strengthen your Church today
to tell our the greatness of your love,
and to express it in acts of service,
for love of him
who came not to be served
but to serve,
your Son our Saviour Jesus Christ.

(MEG)

16 MARCH
Boniface of Ross, Bishop (8th Century) [6] *White*

The name of Cuiritan, or Boniface, is linked with two important Christian sites in Scotland: Restenneth in Angus, where he baptized the Pictish King, Nechtan, in AD 710 and founded a monastery, and Rosemarkie on the Black Isle, where in 716 he refounded a monastery at a place originally associated with Saint Moluag.

Tradition says Boniface came from Italy, or even from Rome. He was of the Roman rather than the Celtic tradition – his foundations are all dedicated to Saint Peter – so Nechtan’s Christianity sought its inspiration from the south rather than from the Celtic west. He was renowned for founding churches. The date of his death is not known.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
we thank thee
for thy servant Boniface,
whom thou didst call
to preach the Gospel
to the people of this land:
raise up, we beseech thee,
in this and every land,
evangelists and heralds
of thy kingdom,
that thy Church may proclaim
the unsearchable riches
of our Saviour Jesus Christ;
who with thee and the Holy Spirit
liveth and reigneth, one God,
now and for ever.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
we thank you
for your servant Boniface,
whom you called
to preach the Gospel
to the people of this land:
raise up in this and every land
evangelists and heralds
of your kingdom,
that your Church may proclaim
the unsearchable riches
of our Saviour Jesus Christ;
who lives and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(ECUSA)

17 MARCH

Patrick, Bishop, Patron of Ireland (461) [4] *White*

Born around the year AD 387 into a Christian Romano-British family, whether in Strathclyde, Cumbria or South Wales is not clear, Patrick was carried off by raiders and enslaved in Ireland. During this time he learned to take religion seriously. After 6 years he escaped, and made his way to the continent, where he studied for the priesthood, probably in Gaul.

In 432 a dream recalled him to Ireland, and he devoted his life to the conversion of the people who had captured him, travelling widely, preaching the Gospel and confounding the druids, often by techniques not much different from their own.

He established his centre of work at Armagh, and his few writings that survive are of great interest. He died in 461, and was buried at Downpatrick.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who in thy providence
didst choose thy servant Patrick
to be the apostle of the Irish people,
that he might bring
those who were wandering
in darkness and error
to the true light and knowledge
of thee:
grant us so to walk in that light,
that we may come at last
to the light of everlasting life;
through the merits of Jesus Christ
thy Son our Lord.

(I)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
in your providence
you chose your servant Patrick
to be the apostle of the Irish people:
keep alive in us
the fire of the faith he kindled
and strengthen us in our pilgrimage
towards the light of everlasting life;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(SEC)

18 MARCH
Cyril of Jerusalem, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith (386)
[6] *White*

Born of Christian parents in AD 315, he succeeded Maximus as Bishop of Jerusalem in 348. He was involved in the Arian controversy and more than once exiled from his diocese. His Catecheses—instructional addresses given to candidates for baptism during Lent and to the newly-baptized at Easter—are testimony to his zeal and his skill as a pastor. They expound the Church's teaching on baptism, confirmation and the Eucharist and are of immense importance, showing why he is honoured as a Doctor of the Church. He died in 386.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Father,
who through Cyril of Jerusalem
didst lead thy Church to a deeper
understanding of the mysteries of
salvation:
grant that the grace of baptism and
of this (the) holy Eucharist may aid
our growth in knowledge of thy
blessed Son, and lead us to the
fullness of eternal life;
through the same thy Son Jesus
Christ our Lord.

(R – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Father,
through Cyril of Jerusalem
you led your Church
to a deeper understanding
of the mysteries of salvation:
by the grace of our baptism
and of this (the) holy Eucharist
help us to know your Son better
and to have eternal life
in all its fullness;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(R – adapted)

19 MARCH
Joseph of Nazareth [4] *White*

Joseph is honoured as a pious Jew, a descendent of King David, and the protector of the Virgin Mary and our Lord. The circumstances of our Lord's birth caused him much distress, but he accepted his vocation, and in obedience to God accepted Mary as his wife, and took her and the infant Jesus to Egypt to escape Herod's slaughter of the innocent.

After Herod's death they returned to Nazareth, where Joseph nurtured Jesus, bringing Him up within their ancestral faith. He earned their livelihood as a carpenter and taught Jesus his trade, and for this reason is honoured as an example of a loving husband and father who seeks to serve God faithfully in the duties of everyday living.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
who from the family
of thy servant David
didst raise up Joseph
to be the guardian of thy incarnate
Son
and the spouse of his virgin mother:
Give us grace to imitate his
uprightness of life and obedience
to thy commands;
through the same thy Son Jesus
Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
who from the family
of your servant David
raised up Joseph the carpenter
to be the guardian
of your incarnate Son
and husband of
the Blessed Virgin Mary:
give us grace to follow him
in faithful obedience
to your commands;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

20 MARCH

Cuthbert, Bishop (687) [6] *White*

Cuthbert was probably born in the Scottish lowlands around the year AD 640, he was a shepherd who became a monk at Melrose under Saint Eata, and undertook long journeys on horseback, year after year, to minister to the scattered people of the Borders and to fan the flames of faith among them.

In 664 he accompanied Eata to Lindisfarne, and later returned to the desolate isle of Farne, where he lived until he was called to be Bishop of Hexham in 684, but almost at once exchanged his see with Eata. He spent only two years as bishop, before retiring again to Farne to die in 687, where his relics eventually found rest in Durham. His is one of the most beautiful character in early British Christianity, marked with compassion and devotion to ordinary people, with a keen eye for and interest in nature. Bede calls him 'a true child of God'.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who didst call Cuthbert
from following the flock
to be a shepherd of thy people:
mercifully grant that,
as he sought out the erring,
even in remote places,
so we, caring for the careless and
lost,
may, after his example,
win souls unto thee;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
you called your servant Cuthbert
from following the flock
to follow your Son
and to be a shepherd of your people:
in your mercy, grant that we,
following his example
and caring for those who are lost,
may bring them home to your fold;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(CCP)

21 MARCH

Thomas Cranmer, Bishop (1556) [6] *Red*

Born at Aslacton in Nottinghamshire in 1489, Thomas Cranmer became a Fellow of Jesus College, Cambridge, where he attracted the notice of Henry VIII, who took him into his service, and in 1532 appointed him Archbishop of Canterbury, despite Cranmer's great reluctance. As the Reformation in England proceeded his own ideas developed, and he was responsible for the dissemination of the Bible in English. His enduring work was the Book of Common Prayer, and his contribution to English liturgy remains unsurpassed. With the accession of Queen Mary, he was caught in the conflict between his Protestant beliefs and his Erastian principles – that the Church should be under state control – and after being tried for heresy he vacillated (fluctuated) for a while before renouncing his various recantations, and faced death at the stake with great courage in 1556.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
our heavenly Father,
may thy Holy Spirit inspire and
renew our worship,
that, after the example of thy servant
Thomas Cranmer,
we may bow our heads in humility
before thy throne of grace,
and lift up our hearts and our voices
in joyful songs of praise;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Everlasting God,
your servant Thomas Cranmer
restored the language of the people
in the prayers of the Church.
Make us always thankful
for this heritage,
and help us so to pray in the Spirit
and with the understanding
that we may worthily glorify
your holy Name;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

22 MARCH

Thomas Ken, Bishop (1711) [6] *White*

After various pastoral cures Thomas Ken became Chaplain to Princess Mary at The Hague, where his strong principles brought him into conflict with William of Orange. As Chaplain to Charles II he refused the use of his house to the king's mistress. In the following year Charles appointed him Bishop of Bath & Wells. He was deposed for refusing to take the Oath of Allegiance to William and Mary, and spent the rest of his life in retirement.

He lived in ascetic simplicity as a celibate, and sought in everything to maintain the whole tradition of the Church "before the disunion of east and west". The author of a number of hymns and a doctrinal work, he died in 1711.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who didst bless thy servant
Thomas Ken
with the graces of integrity,
faithfulness and perseverance:
grant that we too may be faithful
to what we believe,
despising the cost,
and living each moment
as in thy sight,
may with him rise glorious
at the awful day of judgement;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
from whom all blessings flow,
by whose providence we are kept
and by whose grace we are directed:
help us, through the example
of your servant Thomas Ken,
faithfully to keep our word,
humbly to accept adversity,
and steadfastly to worship you;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP – adapted)

24 MARCH

Paul Couturier, Priest (1953) [6] *White*

Born in 1881 in Lyons, Paul Couturier was destined from his earliest years for the priesthood. His concern for Christian Unity had its stirrings in work among Russian refugees in Lyons, and was fostered through his profession at the Benedictine priory at Amay in Belgium, a community devoted to growth of understanding between the Eastern and Western Churches. He commended the observance of a Week of Prayer for Unity, and in the 1930s his contacts widened to incorporate people of the Anglican, Reformed and Lutheran traditions, and his daily Mass became a focussing of his whole life of work and prayer for Unity within the Church. His growing circle of friends and followers became an 'Invisible Monastery', praying for 'the visible unity of the Kingdom of God, such as Christ willed and by the means which He wills'. He died in 1953.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God who didst fire thy servant
Paul Couturier with a vision
of the unity of thy whole Church
and with prophetic zeal
in working and praying
for that unity:
renew us all by thy Holy Spirit,
that we who claim
the Name of Christ
may be drawn by thy love
into one visible fellowship
of worship, mission and service.
that the world may come to His feet
in adoring submission;
who liveth and reigneth with thee
in the unity of the same Spirit,
God for ever and ever.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Father of us all,
you fired your servant
Paul Couturier
with a vision of the unity
of your whole Church
and with prophetic zeal
in working and praying
for its attainment:
renew us by your Holy Spirit,
that we who claim
the Name of Christ
may be drawn by your love
into one visible fellowship
of worship, mission and service.
that the world may come to His feet
in adoring submission;
who now lives and reigns with you
in the unity of the same Spirit,
God for ever and ever.

(MEG)

25 MARCH

THE ANNUNCIATION OF THE LORD [2] *White*

The story of the announcement of the coming of God made flesh in the person of his Son, Jesus the Christ, the Anointed One, is heard in today's proclamation of the good news from the gospel of Luke. The feast marks the conception of Christ in the womb of Mary and has been celebrated in the Church since at least the late 4th century. The perfect humanity and the complete divinity of Jesus is affirmed, following the controversies around those orthodox assertions, which themselves led to the acknowledgement of Mary as *Theotokos*, God-bearer, which in the West became translated as Mother of God. The celebration thus took on strong associations with the person of Mary, and became known in England as Lady Day. In recent years, the Church has re-affirmed the day as a Feast of our Lord, on which his virgin-mother still has a unique place of honour.

(Exciting Holiness, p.142)

1970 Scottish Liturgy

We beseech thee, O Lord,
pour thy grace into our hearts;
that as we have known
the incarnation of thy Son
Jesus Christ
by the message of an angel,
so by his cross and passion
we may be brought unto
the glory of his resurrection;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

We beseech you, O Lord,
pour your grace into our hearts,
that as we have known the
incarnation
of your Son Jesus Christ
by the message of an angel,
so by his cross and passion
we may be brought
to the glory of his resurrection;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

28 MARCH

Patrick Forbes, Bishop (1635), and the Aberdeen Doctors, Teachers of the Faith [6] *White*

Patrick Forbes of Corse was Bishop of Aberdeen from 1618 to 1635, a time of great upheaval in the Scottish Church. He was widely recognized as a man “guid, godly and kynd”. His background was Presbyterian, but he applied himself with great diligence and effect to his episcopal duties.

He was also Chancellor of the University of Aberdeen, and through his work there his name is associated with several colleagues: Robert Baron, First Professor of Theology in Marichal College; William Leslie, Principal of King’s College; James Sibbald, Minister of St Nicholas’s, Aberdeen; Alexander Scroggie, Minister of Old Aberdeen; Alexander Ross, Minister of New Aberdeen; John Forbes, second son of the Bishop and Professor of Divinity in King’s College.

Together they encouraged sound learning and personal godliness, and in the partisan atmosphere of their age found a way to transcend the confessional limits of theological thinking, and to work for harmony, tolerance and mutual understanding in difficult times. They strenuously opposed the National Covenant which abolished episcopacy in Scotland; John Forbes was deprived of his chair in 1639 for refusing to subscribe to it, and driven into exile when he refused to accept the Solemn League and Covenant.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Keep, we beseech thee, O Lord, thy
Church with thy perpetual mercy;
and as in troubled days of old
thou didst raise up leaders of
integrity and peace to guide her by
the example of true godliness,
so today fill the hearts
of all thy people with that love
that transcends the barriers of
suspicion and distrust, and grant
that, being drawn closer to thee,
they may find a new unity
in thy service;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who enlightened your Church
by the teaching of your servants
Patrick Forbes and the Aberdeen
Doctors:
enrich it evermore with your
heavenly grace
and raise up faithful witnesses
who, by their life and teaching,
may proclaim the truth of your
salvation;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

29 MARCH

John Keble, Priest (1866) [6] *White*

The son of a priest, born at Fairford in 1792, John Keble had a brilliant career at Oxford, but resigned his fellowship to assist his father in his Cotswold parish, where his devotional poems, “The Christian Year”, were written.

Alarmed by the effects of reforming trends within the Church of England, Keble associated himself with the Tractarians, preaching the famous Assize Sermon in 1833 on ‘National Apostasy’. He studied the writings of the Fathers in depth, and sought to recall the Church to her primitive heritage and the Catholic tradition of undivided Christendom.

In 1836 he became Vicar of Hursley, where he remained, a devoted parish priest, for the rest of his life. His beauty of character impressed all who came into contact with him, and his advice on spiritual matters was widely sought.

He died in 1866.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Eternal God, who didst call
thy servant John Keble
to proclaim thy glory
in a life of priestly prayer
and pastoral zeal,
and didst adorn him
with so many excellent gifts
and graces:
keep all thy priests, we beseech thee,
faithful to the teaching
of thy Son Jesus Christ
and united to Him in love,
and bless thy people through their
ministry;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SA – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Father of the eternal Word,
in whose encompassing love
all things in peace and order move:
grant that, as your servant
John Keble
adored you in all creation,
so we may have
a humble heart of love
for the mysteries of your Church,
and know your love
to be new every morning
in Jesus Christ our Lord,
who is alive and reigns
with you and the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(CCP)

March

1	David, Bishop, Patron of Wales, c.544	6	White
2	Chad of Lichfield, Bishop, 672	6	White
3	John and Charles Wesley, Priests, 1791, 1788	6	White
4	Adrian of May Island, Abbot, and Companions, Martyrs, 875	6	Red
5	—	—	—
6	Baldred, Bishop, 608	6	White
7	Perpetua and her Companions, Martyrs, 203	6	Red
8	Duthac, Bishop, 1068	6	White
9	—	—	—
10	Kessog, Bishop, c.700	6	Red
11	—	—	—
12	—	—	—
13	—	—	—
14	—	—	—
15	—	—	—
16	Boniface of Ross, Bishop, 8th Century	6	White
17	Patrick, Bishop, Patron of Ireland, 461	4	White
18	Cyril of Jerusalem, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith, 386	6	White
19	Joseph of Nazareth	4	White
20	Cuthbert, Bishop, 687	6	White
21	Thomas Cranmer, Bishop, 1556	6	Red
22	Thomas Ken, Bishop, 1711	6	White
23	—	—	—
24	Paul Couturier, Priest, 1953	6	White
25	THE ANNUNCIATION OF THE LORD	2	White
26	—	—	—
27	—	—	—
28	Patrick Forbes, Bishop, 1635, and the Aberdeen Doctors, Teachers of the Faith	6	White
29	John Keeble, Priest, 1866	6	White
30	—	—	—
31	—	—	—